
STORY OF A WOMAN CRUSOE

Unlike Defoe's Hero. Her End Is Pa-
thetic in the Extreme.

Beginning due west of Point Concep-
tion, on the California coast, and con-
tinuing at irregular intervals as far
south as the Bay of Todos Santos, in
lower California lie the Channel Isl-
ands. In this ideal region for the
yachtsman, the fisherman and the hun-
ter one comes to feel like a new Crusoe
on his primitive isle. And in very
truth Crusoe's semi-mythical story was
enacted upon one of these same islands
though minus the man Friday and the
happy ending.

The castaway in this case was a wo-
man, a Danish emigrant, left ashore
through some mischance by the crew of
a vessel that had sought shelter be-
hind San Nicholas during a storm in
the early '50's. For over seventeen
years the lone creature lived unsought
and forgotten, though the time at
length came when, on the rays the
mist-clearing north wind blew, she
could climb to the island's highest
point and view the ranchers' herds
grazing upon the mainland.

And at last, when hope and reason
had both long died, the poor, wild,
gibbering creature was found in her
wolf's burrow among the rills by the
advance guard of the otter hunters'
fraternity, who had long wondered at
the mysterious foot-prints they mark-
ed upon the lonely sands.—From Field
and Stream.
